

those have more than five. They also found that having more friends is linked to being more satisfied with those friendships. (Because no woman can do it all, amiright?) I (Jen) find that the older I become and the more kids I have, the harder it gets to maintain friendships. And while my five-year-old says I'm his best friend, we have vastly different interests. There are seasons in life when we get to prioritize friendships more highly than others. Part of values-based spending is knowing when you're in one of those seasons and embracing it (another topic we'll get into soon). It's also about knowing when to shift. Some friendships are long-term, but many are given to us for shorter seasons. When I stopped going out, I gave up some friendships with people who were more interested in going out than building relationships. But I've picked up others, like moms who also lack the interests of their five-year-old boys. As we get more creative with meeting our needs of friendship and belonging in a way that fits our budget, we naturally fall into places with like-minded people. It's okay to grieve the loss of relationships that were good and be thankful for new relationships that are healthier for where we're going.

Next is **faith**, a subject we understand brings up unique feelings depending on who you ask. Whether your spiritual practice is organized, organic, or a combination of both, we believe having one is essential to all our internal needs, primarily self-actualization. Learning, volunteering, meditation, prayer, journaling, and spending time in nature are all ways we can connect to our greater purpose and make sense of a world too complex to fully understand. And generosity, whether to a church or organization you love, has been reported to have strong associations with psychological health and well-being.<sup>5</sup> An intentional spiritual practice can also make us more mindful of the spaces around us. It can even allow us to see our homes as a personal sanctuary where we can reflect and recharge. When you value your spiritual practice, things like limiting your consumption (and thereby your clutter), investing in the right home-improvement projects, and spending mindfully aren't just money-saving ideas, they're value-aligned actions.

Finally, we have **fulfilling work**. The great thing about fulfilling work is that it shouldn't cost anything, it should pay you! (A great phrase to use on the next girl boss trying to recruit you for her network marketing business!) Fulfilling work covers a variety of internal and external needs: the security of a paycheck, confidence, achievement, creativity, and more. A few years